

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7 6 3
♥ 9 4
♦ 10 5 2
♣ Q J 10 4

♠ A K J 5
♥ A J 10 5
♦ A 6 4
♣ 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 9 2
♥ Q 7 3
♦ 9 8 7
♣ K 9 6 2

♠ Q 4
♥ K 8 6 2
♦ K Q J 3
♣ A 7 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
your winners.

The 2♣ bid was Stayman, so you bid your ♥s.

Partner takes the direct approach and puts you in slam.

South plays 6♥. West leads the ♣Q. West finds their best lead, exposing your ♣ loser right off the bat.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 2

If you can guess the ♥ finesse correctly you will make 7, discarding dummy's ♣ loser on the fourth ♦. But if you guess wrong they will immediately set you with a ♣ trick.

There is a better way - one that combines two chances. Win the ♣A. Then play your ♥A and ♥K. If the ♥Q happens to fall, pull the last trump and run

If the ♥Q **DOESN'T** fall, (she won't of course), switch to ♦s. On the fourth round of ♦s discard dummy's ♣, whether it is ruffed with the ♥Q or not.

If you knew to play the East for the ♥Q then you wouldn't need this improved plan.

But playing the deal as described will win whenever the ♥Q is doubleton, **OR** when the player with the protected ♥Q holds at least 3 ♦s.

Pretty good odds, better than the going rate for finesses, which is 50% off.

There was an alternate plan, just as good. After taking the two top trumps, run the ♠s, discarding two ♣s from your hand. As you see, either would have worked.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 8 5 3

♥ K 5

♦ 8 7 4 3

♣ 9 3

♠ 6 2

♥ A 10 9

♦ 10 6 5

♣ K Q 7 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 7

♥ 8 7 6 4 2

♦ A 9

♣ 10 8 2

♠ Q J 4

♥ Q J 3

♦ K Q J 2

♣ A J 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

have seen the ♠4 and ♠2 so it is clear that West started with a 5-card suit. That means East still has a ♠.

The instant you play a ♦ one of the defenders will grab the ♦A and West will take his three more ♠ tricks.

As much as you hate to put your contract in the hands of a 50% finesse chance, that is what you must do.

Forget the ♦ suit and finesse West for the ♥K, trying for two extra tricks in ♥s.

West played very well to duck the second ♠, leaving his partner with a ♠ in case he could get the lead.

So you have to play well and stay away from ♦s.

Partner's 2NT bid invites you to bid game if you have a maximum hand. You aren't thrilled by all the Quacks in your hand but with 17 points you bid 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠5. East wins the first trick with the ♠K and returns the ♠9. West plays the ♠3 under your ♠J.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 5 :: Total = 7

You need 2 more tricks, and the ♦ suit will provide them after you drive out the ♦A.

Is that what you should do?

That is definitely **NOT** what you should do. West led the ♠5, then played the ♠3 to the second trick. You

Board 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 6
♥ 6
♦ K 8 5 4 2
♣ Q 9 3

♠ A K 5 4
♥ A 3 2
♦ Q J 10
♣ J 7 6



♠ 9 8 3 2
♥ 10 4
♦ 9 7 6 3
♣ K 10 5

♠ 7
♥ K Q J 9 8 7 5
♦ A
♣ A 8 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 3

It can't do any good to ruff your fourth ♣ in dummy because you would have to lose two before that could happen. Of course one of your ♣s can be discarded on dummy's ♠K but what about the other two?

Suppose you win the ♠ and unblock the ♦A. Play ♥K, then to dummy's ♥A. Take one ♣ discard on the ♠K, then play the ♦Q and discard a second ♣.

It won't work. You would establish the ♦ for your last discard but you have no entry to it.

This will work. At trick 2 discard the ♦A on dummy's ♠K. Play the ♦Q and discard a ♣ when East doesn't cover. West will take the ♦K and attack ♣s but you are in control now. You win your ♣A, pull trumps, ending in dummy, and discard the remaining 2 ♣ losers on dummy's ♦J 10.

This is called a Jettison play. You sacrifice your ♦A to unblock the suit for dummy's ♦Q J 10.

If East held the ♦K the play would be slightly different; you would have to ruff when he covered. But the result would be the same.

Did you notice that you started with 3 ♣ losers and no ♦ loser, but you ended up losing 1 ♦ and no ♣s?

There would be nothing wrong with a transfer bid here, but probably no advantage either. What you really want to know is how many Aces partner has. So you ask him with a Gerber 4♣ bid.

Partner says 4♠ (2 Aces),

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Partner says 4♠ (2 Aces),

Looking at three possible ♣ losers you bid 6♥.

South plays 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. The first trick is easy; you win with dummy's ♠A.